

CLS Requests — User Guide

Current Level of Service budget requests • Beacon Performance & Budgeting • Agency Writers, Agency Submitters, BBMR Reviewers

What a CLS request is

A Current Level of Service (CLS) request asks BBMR to fund the cost of maintaining your agency's current level of service next fiscal year — a mandated cost increase, a cyclical cost, extraordinary inflation, and so on. Requests are summarized by initiative or project rather than broken out by individual spend category: you give one total for the request, then break that total out by expenditure object and, where relevant, by position.

Who does what

Role	Can do	Where
Agency Writer	Create and fill in requests; submit a request to the Agency Submitter.	CLS Requests
Agency Submitter	Everything a writer can do, plus send an individual request on to BBMR. Holds final sign-off for the agency.	CLS Requests
BBMR Reviewer	Review submitted requests, record analyst notes and the BBMR decision. Opens requests read-only.	CLS Review
Agency Viewer	Read-only access to the agency's requests.	CLS Requests

How a request moves

Status	Set when	Who
In Progress	the request is created	Writer
Agency Review	Submit is selected on that request	Writer
BBMR Review	Send to BBMR is selected on that request	Submitter
Approved / Partially Approved / Denied	the BBMR approval is recorded	BBMR Reviewer

Each request moves on its own — submitting one does not submit the rest. Only requests sent on by an Agency Submitter reach BBMR for review. Each status carries its own colour on the list page.

For Agency Writers

You do the data entry: create each request, describe it, and break the money out. When a request is complete, you submit it to your Agency Submitter.

Start a request

- 1 In the left navigation under **Budget Planning**, choose **CLS Requests**. The page is titled with your agency name and lists every request your agency has created.
- 2 Select **Add CLS Request**. This opens a full request page — there are no pop-ups. The request is created straight away, so you can add objects and positions before the summary is finished. It shows on the list with a red **Not detailed** badge until it is complete.

Fill in the summary

- 1 **Request name** — name the initiative. The page heading and the sentence above the form update as you type.
- 2 **Service** — choose the service in your agency the request supports.
- 3 **Request type** — choose the adjustment type. Select the ☐ icon beside the label if you are unsure; the full reference table opens directly below the field (see the next page).
- 4 **Request duration** — the toggle reads **Recurring Request** by default. Switch it on for a **One-Time Request**; the FY29 and FY30 fields are then hidden and cleared. The ☐ icon here explains when a multi-year contract counts as recurring.
- 5 **FY28 / FY29 / FY30 Amount** — the FY28 amount is the request total. **A recurring request must give FY29 and FY30 as well**, and they should assume any year-over-year increase. Amounts take whole dollars only: separators appear as you type, and decimals are not accepted.
- 6 **Summarize the request** — required. A short explanation of the request for review, with a **150-word limit**. The counter beneath the box turns red and tells you the exact overage if you go long; anything past 150 words is cut off for review.
- 7 There is no Save button. The page **saves automatically** as you type, from the first keystroke. The indicator beside the back link shows when it last saved; hover it to see who saved.

Break the money out

A banner above **Request details** tracks whether the money is fully explained. It reads “The total request needs to explain \$...” while there is money left, turns green when it balances, and warns “The total request exceeds \$...” if the parts add up to more than the FY28 amount. **Both objects and positions count toward that total.**

- 1 Under **Request details**, pick an **Object**, enter its **Amount**, and give a one-line **Justification**. Select **Add Details**. Use one line per object.
- 2 Repeat until the banner confirms the request is fully described.
- 3 If the request creates positions, tick **Add positions to this request** (off by default) and complete the classification, **Position Count**, **Estimated Cost**, and the two justification fields. Unticking the box clears what you had started typing.
- 4 **Add Details** and **Add position** stay greyed out until every field in their form is filled in.

- 5 To change a row you have already added, select the **pen** at the end of it. The row becomes editable in place, with tick and cross buttons to save or cancel.

Submit it

- 1 Return to **CLS Requests** using the back link. A complete request leaves without comment. If something is missing you are told what, and a blank mandatory field will stop you leaving until it is filled in.
- 2 On that request's row, select **Submit** and confirm. The status becomes **Agency Review** and your Agency Submitter takes it from there.

If something is missing

Required fields you have left blank are outlined in **red**, and the request carries a red **Not detailed** badge on the list page — hover it for the specific list. The banner above Request details tells you how much of the request is still unexplained. A reminder near the top names your Agency Submitter and the deadline, and the top of the list page names your agency's Submitters and its BBMR **Budget Analyst**.

Request type reference

Adjustment type	Use it for	Example
Annualization of Cost	Full-year funding for something funded for part of FY27.	A new lease funded for part of FY27 needs annualizing in FY28.
Capital Project	Operating cost for a capital project coming online in FY28.	A renovated facility reopens in FY28.
Cyclical Cost	Costs that recur by the nature of the service.	Election costs.
Debt Service	Projected changes to debt service in FY28.	Updating a conditional purchase agreement to the debt schedule.
Extraordinary Inflation	Costs growing faster than the standard CLS inflation adjustment.	Expenditures growing more than 5% from inflation.
Grant Match	Local match for a state or federal grant (not replacing lost grant funds).	The local match on a 3-year grant grows each year.
Mandated Cost	Increases driven by a legal or contractual mandate.	Operating costs from recent Council legislation.
Remove One-Time Item	Removing FY27 funding that was only ever for one year.	One-time equipment funding comes out of the base.

Expenditure objects

Transfers • Salaries • Other Personnel Costs • Contractual Services • Materials and Supplies • Minor Equipment (<\$5k) • Major Equipment (>\$5k) • Grants, Subsidies, and Contributions • Debt Service

For Agency Submitters

You see exactly the same pages and the same editing tools as an Agency Writer. The difference is the action on each row: instead of **Submit**, you get **Send to BBMR**. Nothing reaches BBMR until you send it.

Reviewing before you send

- 1 Open **CLS Requests**. Sort by **Status** to group everything sitting in **Agency Review**.
- 2 Select **Modify** on a request to open it. You can change anything a writer can — the name, service, type, duration, amounts, summary, objects and positions. Edits save automatically.
- 3 Check that the banner above **Request details** confirms the request is fully described. If it still says money needs explaining, the breakdown is incomplete.
- 4 Confirm the summary reads clearly and the justifications will make sense to someone outside the agency.

Sending a request to BBMR

- 1 Back on **CLS Requests**, select **Send to BBMR** on that request's row.
- 2 Confirm in the dialog, which names the request. The status becomes **BBMR Review** and the request is marked complete.
- 3 Send requests individually — sending one leaves the others untouched, so you can hold anything that is not ready.

After sending

The **Status** column is where you follow what happens next: it becomes **Approved**, **Partially Approved** or **Denied** once BBMR records a decision. A sent request can no longer be edited or deleted — its row shows a lock in place of Delete. Use **Export request(s)** below the table for an Excel workbook (request summary, line items and personnel on separate tabs) or a PDF of the full detail. Both carry your agency name in the file name, and the workbook records who created and last changed each request, and when.

For BBMR Reviewers

You work from **CLS Review**, which spans every agency. Your notes and decision are stored separately from what the agency submitted, so the original request is never overwritten. Opening a request shows it read-only for the same reason — your decision belongs on this page, not in the agency's submission.

Reading the page

Card	What it counts
Pending Requests	Every CLS request, at any status.
Requests for Review	Only those an agency has sent to BBMR.
Total requested	Total dollars across those sent-to-BBMR requests.
Total positions	Total positions across those requests.

Beneath the cards, **Request volume** charts requested dollars by agency — hover a bar for that agency's request count, or use **Hide chart** to fold it away. Approved, partially approved, denied and undecided dollars stack in different colours; on a partial approval only the amount you actually approved shows as partially approved, and the rest appears as **Not approved**. A labelled divider separates this overview from the review work below it.

Finding requests

- 1 Use the **Status**, **Agency** and **Service** filters. Each opens a panel of checkboxes with **Select all** and **Clear**; the closed control summarises what is chosen ("All status", "3 of 6 selected").
- 2 Tick everything you want, then select **Apply**. The table reloads once, when you apply or close the panel — not on every tick.
- 3 **Reset filters** goes back to everything.

Recording a decision

- 1 Select a row in **Review requests** to expand it. You see the service, type, FY28/29/30 amounts, duration, object and position rollups, and the agency's summary.
- 2 **Analyst approval** is advisory — it records the analyst's recommendation and does **not** change the request's status.
- 3 **BBMR approval** is the decision that counts: Approved, Partial or Denied. Saving it sets the request's status to **Approved**, **Partially Approved** or **Denied**, which the agency then sees.
- 4 Add **Analyst notes** as needed, then select **Save review**.
- 5 **Approved FY28** and **Approved positions** appear as soon as you choose Approved or Partial. Approved pre-fills from the request; Partial starts blank so you enter what was actually approved. These are the figures the agency sees, and the chart uses them.
- 6 To see the request itself, select **Open request**. It opens read-only, and the back link returns you to CLS Review.

Deciding several at once

- 1 Filter down to the set you want to decide, then select **Bulk Approve**. The request table is replaced by one line per request: Agency, Service, Request, Type, FY28, Duration and Positions as read-only context, then **BBMR approval**, **Appr. FY28** and **Appr. pos.** to fill in.
- 2 Leave a row's approval blank to skip it.
- 3 **Save and close** writes every row that has a decision and returns to the normal table. **Cancel** leaves without saving.

Exporting

Export all agencies above the table produces an Excel workbook covering requests and decisions, line items and personnel. When the Agency filter is narrowed to a single agency, the file name says so. Each request carries its created and last-modified date and the email address behind each.

What agencies see

Agencies do not see your analyst notes. They see the resulting **Status** on their CLS Requests page.

The screens

Schematic layouts. Field order and labels match the app; replace with screenshots when available.

Header: agency name • guidance text • <i>Submitter: ...</i> • <i>Budget Analyst: ...</i>
Cards + chart: in progress • sent • total requested • positions • volume by service
Bar: + Add CLS Request
Table (sortable): Request name Service Amount (\$K/\$M) Status actions
Row actions: <i>Submit</i> (writer) or <i>Send to BBMR</i> (submitter) • Delete (or a lock, once sent) • Modify →
Below the table: Export request(s) — Excel • PDF

Figure 1. The list page. The row action depends on your role and the request's status.

Top row: ← Back to CLS requests <i>Last Saved 7/29/26 at 2:45 PM</i> (hover for user)
Reminder: send to [Agency Submitters] before the deadline
Summary: request name (title updates live) • intro sentence • Service • Request type ■ • Request duration toggle ■ • FY28 / FY29 / FY30 • Summarize the request (150 words)
Banner: total request needs to explain / exceeds / fully described
Request details: Object • Amount • Justification → <i>Add Details</i> , then the object table
Position requests: hidden until <i>Add positions to this request</i> is ticked

Figure 2. The request page. Everything for one request lives here; edits autosave.

Cards: Pending Requests • Requests for Review • Total requested • Total positions
Chart: requested dollars by agency (hover for counts)
— REVIEW —
Filters: Status • Agency • Service — checkbox panels with <i>Apply</i> • <i>Reset filters</i>
Table: Request Agency Service Positions FY28 Status — select a row to expand
Expanded: submitted detail • Analyst recommendation (advisory) • BBMR approval (sets status) • Approved FY28 / positions • Analyst notes • <i>Open request</i> • <i>Save review</i>
Bulk approve: replaces the table with one row per request • <i>Save and close</i>

Figure 3. The BBMR review workspace.